

Georgetown Orthodox Christian Fellowship
Vespers: Tuesday, August 18, 2026
Memory of the Holy Apostles Jason and Sosipater
Feel free to read or chant during the service!

Stichera

Tone 2. *If You, O Lord, should mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand? For with You there is forgiveness.*

As they heard the Angel's joyful words, * Christ's women disciples were filled with divine and sacred joy. * Thus they were made certain of the resurrection of Him, * who for us was counted among * the dead, and for whom they * previously as Myrrh-bearers had lamented and mourned, * standing near the tomb; and they wondered * who would move the stone, and they looked up, * suddenly the stone was rolled away for them.

Because of Your Name have I waited for You, O Lord; my soul has waited upon Your word, my soul has hoped in the Lord. Joy that is divine and never ends: * that is what the Myrrh-bearing women, lady disciples of Christ, gave to the Disciples, that divine and sacred band, thus obeying the order of the Lord's holy Angel, * who had dazzled them before with his most luminous robe. * They announced that Hades was ruined * by the all-saving resurrection * of our King and Lord who died on our behalf.

From the morning watch until night, from the morning watch let Israel trust in the Lord. Christ's women disciples stopped their tears, * tears that flowed from fountains of mourning and lamentation; and now * they bring the eye-witnesses of grace the joyful words. * For they come and announce to them * the Lord's resurrection, * that the Logos has arisen, bringing joy from the tomb, * and that they had wondrously heard His * voice commanding them to rejoice now, * the opposite of pain and sorrow from of old.

Tone 1. *For with the Lord there is mercy and with Him is abundant redemption, and He will deliver Israel from all his iniquities.* O glorious Saints, you left behind * every form of luxury, * in love with Christ as you were; and you attached your souls to Him, * following His footsteps. * You offered yourselves to Him, * all-wise Apostles Jason and Sosipater. Intercede with Him * and entreat Him that surpassing peace * and great mercy * be upon our souls bestowed.

Praise the Lord, all you nations; praise Him, all you peoples. My soul has been darkened by the mist * of the passions, hence I pray * that you, O Jason and Sosipater, might illumine it. * By your divine teachings, * you enlightened all the world, * diminishing the gloom of idolatry and adding multitudes * of the human race to all those saved * from their error, * and led them to Christ our God.

For His mercy is great towards us, and the truth of the Lord endures forever. Christ our God and Savior sent you out * as Apostles to recall * the lost, O Jason and Sosipater, and to bring them back. * And He led all people * to salvation by your words * and teachings that were full of divine wisdom. Now intercede with Him, * and entreat Him that surpassing peace * and great mercy * be upon our souls bestowed.

Tone 2. *Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.* The myrrh-bearing women arrived at your sepulcher, and they saw the seals on the gravestone, but they did not find Your immaculate Body, O Lord. They had come in all earnestness, and lamenting they said, "Who has stolen our hope? Who took away the dead man, naked and covered with myrrh, his mother's only consolation? He who revived the dead, oh, how has He died? He who plundered Hades, how was He buried? Nevertheless,

arise, O Savior, by Your own authority, on the third day, as You said You would, and save our souls.”

Aposticha

Tone 2 For the Cross. By the power of Your Cross, save me, O Christ my Savior, Who saved Peter in the sea, and have mercy on me, O God. Resurrectional.

I lift my eyes to You, who dwell in heaven. Behold, as the eyes of servants look to the hands of their masters, as the eyes of the maidservant look to the hands of her mistress, so our eyes look to the Lord our God until He shall have compassion on us. Let us join the Archangels and extol the Resurrection of Christ. He is the Redeemer and Savior of our souls; and He will come again, in awesome glory and mighty power, to judge the world which He created.

Have mercy on us, O Lord, have mercy on us, for we are greatly filled with contempt; our soul is greatly filled with it. We are a disgrace to those who prosper, and a contempt to the arrogant. The companies of Martyrs withstood the tyrants and said: We are soldiers enlisted by the King of hosts. Though you consume us with tortures and fire, yet we do not deny the power of the Trinity.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen. Joseph asked for the Body of Jesus, and he laid it in his own new tomb; for Jesus had to emerge from the grave as from His bridal chamber. “You who shattered the dominion of death and opened the gates of Paradise for all mankind, glory to You!”

Apolytikion

Tone 2 When You descended unto Death, O Lord, You who are immortal Life put Hades to death, by the lightning of Your divinity. And when You raised the dead from the netherworld, all the hosts of heaven sang aloud to You, “O Christ God, Giver of life, glory to You!”

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. When he took down Your immaculate Body from the Cross, the honorable Joseph wrapped it in a clean linen shroud with spices and laid it for burial in a new tomb. But on the third day You rose, O Lord, and granted to the world the great mercy.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen. The Angel who had come to the sepulcher said to the Myrrh-bearing women, “Ointments are appropriate for mortal men; but Christ is indeed a stranger to decay. Now go proclaim that the Lord has risen and granted to the world the great mercy.”

Troparion for Mary of Egypt Tone 8 In you the image was preserved with exactness, O Mother; for taking up your cross, you did follow Christ, and by your deeds you did teach us to overlook the flesh, for it passes away, but to attend to the soul since it is immortal. Wherefore, O righteous Mary, your spirit rejoices with the Angels.